

Persona Classification System for Marketing Operations

Last Updated: December 2025

Owner: Marketing Operations

Status: Active

Note: This document supersedes the previous [Marketing Operations - Inferred Personas](#) documentation. The classification system has been significantly enhanced with AI-driven enrichment via Clay, expanded taxonomy, and improved scoring logic.

Overview

The goal of persona identification is to provide a normalized structure of a person's role and interests that helps us better target them with our GTM efforts. By combining demographic variables, behavioral signals, and AI-driven enrichment, we build an inference model to identify personas.

For this document, persona refers to normalized data about a person's role and interests related to Benchling. The list of "Personas" is living. It changes all the time but the key is managing the inputs to defining their persona in a way that is extensible.

How to Use Personas

Inferred Persona is the primary field on the Lead and Contact objects in Salesforce that identifies a person's main persona.

Important disclaimers:

- **Single Persona Assignment:** Each person is tagged with only one Inferred Persona, although they may fit within umbrella personas. For example, Cell & Gene Therapy Research is part of Research, which is part of the broader R&D audience.
 - **Marketing Eligibility:** Not everyone with an Inferred Persona is eligible for marketing communications. When running Salesforce reports, filter using **Eligible for Marketing Emails = True**.
 - **Accuracy Expectations:** Inferred Persona is based on demographic and behavioral inference—we do not expect 100% accuracy. The system improves over time as new information becomes available.
 - **Dynamic Classification:** A person's Inferred Persona can change over time based on their engagement patterns and updated profile information.
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Classification Dimensions

To identify “Inferred Persona” we use data across a few different fields. While “Inferred Pesona” is our main data point, it can be useful to reference the source fields directly for segmentation.

These fields are used as inputs to identifying a person's persona.

Dimension	Source	Status
Seniority	Automated (Marketo/Clay title parsing)	Active
Function	Manual (SDR)	⚠ Targeted for Deprecation

Use Case	Manual (SDR)	⚠ Targeted for Deprecation
Department	Automated (Clay) + Manual (SDR/Form Fill)	Active
AI Identified Interests	Automated (Clay)	Active
AI Identified Persona	Automated (Clay)	Active
Interest Scores	Behavioral (Marketo)	Active

Dimension Definitions

Seniority

Source: Identified automatically from title keywords via Marketo and Clay workflows.

Seniority indicates the person's level within their organization (e.g., Individual Contributor, Manager, Director, VP, Executive) and informs routing, messaging, and sales prioritization.

Possible Seniority Levels with examples:

Executive - Csuite and Founders.

VP - VP in the title

Director - Director in the title, for science this is equivalent to a PI

Manager - Manager or Lab manager

Mid-Level - Scientists

Entry - Research Assistants

Function

Status: Targeted for Deprecation

Source: Manually entered by SDRs.

This legacy field will be replaced by improved automated classification through Department and AI Identified Interests.

Use Case

Status: Targeted for Deprecation

Replacement: Department + AI Identified Interests

Source: Manually entered by SDRs from a fixed list.

Valid Use Case Values:

Category	Use Cases
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Research/Discovery	Antibody and Protein Research, Gene Therapy Research, Cell Therapy Research, Strain Research, RNA Therapeutics Research, Small Molecule Research, Diagnostics Research, Next-Generation Sequencing, High-throughput Screening, Other Research/Discovery
Process/Analytical Development	Antibody and Protein Process Development, Gene Therapy Process Development, Cell Therapy Process Development, Strain Process Development, RNA Therapeutics Process Development, Analytical Development and Testing, Small Molecule Process Development, Device Development, Other Process/Analytical Development
Bioanalytical	Bioanalytical Development and Testing, In vivo studies, Other Bioanalytical/Bioanalysis
Manufacturing	MSAT (Manufacturing Science and Technologies), Clinical batch production, Commercial Batch Production, Other Manufacturing

Quality & Other	Biobanking, Diagnostics Development, Quality Control Clinical, Quality Control Commercial, Other Core Services
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Department

Source:

- Primary: AI-identified via Clay enrichment using LinkedIn profile signals
- Secondary: Manual input by SDR or end-user form fill

Classification Logic: Prioritizes signals from the person's CURRENT role (headline, current position, recent experience). Past roles are weighted lower but used as tiebreakers when current role signals are ambiguous.

Valid Department Values:

Department	Description
Discovery & Research	Early-stage research scientists focused on target identification, assay development, and discovery science

Preclinical & Translational Sciences	Scientists studying drug behavior—DMPK, pharmacology, biomarker development, translational medicine
Toxicology	Scientists evaluating drug toxicity—GLP toxicologists, genetic toxicologists, pathologists
Safety Pharmacology	Scientists evaluating drug effects on vital organ systems (cardiovascular, CNS, respiratory)
Process Development	Scientists developing manufacturing processes—upstream, downstream, cell line development
Analytical Development	Scientists developing analytical methods—characterization, mass spectrometry, method validation
Formulation & Drug Product	Scientists developing final drug product forms—formulation, drug delivery, lyophilization

Manufacturing Sciences	Scientists/engineers supporting tech transfer and production—MSAT, process engineering
Cell & Gene Therapy	Scientists developing cell-based therapies (CAR-T) and gene therapies (AAV, lentiviral)
Clinical Development	Teams designing and executing clinical trials—clinical ops, biostatistics
Regulatory Affairs	Professionals managing regulatory submissions and agency interactions
Quality	Teams ensuring quality standards—QA, QC, compliance, validation
Medical Affairs	Teams engaging healthcare providers—MSLs, medical communications, HEOR
Pharmacovigilance & Drug Safety	Teams monitoring post-approval drug safety

R&D IT / Scientific Computing	Teams building R&D IT infrastructure—LIMS, ELN, lab systems
Data Science & Bioinformatics	Scientists applying computational methods—bioinformatics, AI/ML, genomics
Manufacturing / Quality IT	Teams building manufacturing/quality IT—MES, QMS, batch records
Program & Portfolio Management	Teams managing R&D projects and portfolios
Agriculture R&D	R&D roles in agricultural biotechnology
Academic	Academic researchers and faculty
Other	Roles that don't fit above categories

AI Identified Interests

Source: Automated via Clay enrichment by scraping the user's LinkedIn profile and searching the web for related projects.

Valid Interest Tags:

Interest Tag	Description
R&D	Early-stage research and development across life sciences
Process Development	Design, optimization, and scale-up of manufacturing processes
Analytical Development	Methods for characterizing and validating therapeutics quality
Manufacturing	Production workflows, GMP standards, scale-up strategies
In Vivo	Studies in living organisms—preclinical models, PK, efficacy

Antibody	Monoclonal antibodies, bispecifics, antibody engineering
Gene Therapy	Genetic material delivery, vectors, delivery systems
Cell Therapy	Engineered cell-based therapies, CAR-T
Protein	Recombinant proteins, enzyme engineering
RNA Therapeutics	mRNA, siRNA, antisense oligonucleotides
Small Molecule	Chemical therapeutics discovery and development
High Throughput Sequencing / NGS	Genomic and transcriptomic sequencing technologies
Microbial Strains	Engineering microbial systems
Industrial Biotech	Biological systems for industrial bio-based goods

Food & Agriculture	Biotech in crop science, livestock, fermentation
CRO/CMO	Contract research or manufacturing organizations
Biopharma	Industry trends from biotech/pharma
Automation	Lab automation, robotics, streamlined workflows
AI/LLM	Artificial intelligence and LLMs in R&D
Security	Data integrity, access control, compliance
Data Analysis	Techniques for experimental and bioinformatics data

AI Identified Persona

Source: Automated via Clay enrichment by scraping the user's LinkedIn profile and searching the web for related projects.

Valid Persona Tags:

Persona	Description
Development Scientist	Post-discovery scientist focused on candidate refinement, process optimization, regulatory readiness
Bench Scientist / Wet Lab Scientist	Hands-on experimentalists—pipetting, cell culture, running assays
Dry Lab Scientist / Data Scientist	Computational professionals working with models and large datasets
R&D Executive	Strategic leaders overseeing scientific programs. Includes C-Suite, VP+, "Chief" titles, Founders at R&D companies
IT	Technical experts enabling infrastructure, software, security for scientific workflows
Product or Lab Management	People overseeing large products, projects, or labs (not executive level)

Developers	Software Engineers/Bioinformaticians building tools and platforms for scientists
Business	Non-technical roles—marketing, sales, finance, HR, consulting. (Executives at R&D companies → R&D Executive)
Academic	Students and faculty at research institutions

Inferred Persona (Final Output)

Source: Calculated via Workato workflow combining all classification dimensions and interest scores.

Inferred Persona is the culmination of all data points to route each person to their single best-matching persona. While a person may match multiple personas, this field represents the primary classification.

Valid Inferred Persona Values:

Inferred Persona	Description
Academic	Academic users or contacts at Institution accounts

IT	Information technology professionals
Other/Non-target	Does not fit target personas
Cell & Gene Therapy Research	Research focus on cell and gene therapy modalities
RNA Research	Research focus on RNA therapeutics
Antibody Research	Research focus on antibody development
Process Development	Focus on manufacturing process development
Bioanalytical Development	Focus on bioanalytical methods and testing
Food & Ag	Focus on food and agriculture biotech
Industrial Biotech	Focus on industrial biotechnology applications

Research	General research/discovery (not modality-specific)
Development	General development (not modality-specific)
R&D	Broad R&D classification (umbrella)

Persona Hierarchy: Personas exist within an umbrella structure. For example:

- Cell & Gene Therapy Research → Research → R&D
- Process Development → Development → R&D

Interest Scoring System

Interest scores track behavioral engagement with specific topics. Each relevant touchpoint adds **+1 point** to the corresponding score field.

Example: Attending an AI webinar = +1 to AI score field.

Score Fields (MKTO PER Score)

Score Field	Topic Tracked
AI	AI/LLM engagement

Antibody	Antibody-related engagement
Automation	Automation engagement
BioAnalytical Dev	Bioanalytical development
C&G	Cell & Gene therapy
DataAnalysis	Data analysis
Dev	Development (general)
Food & Ag	Food & Agriculture
Industrial Biotech	Industrial biotech
InVivo	In vivo studies

IT	IT/infrastructure
MolBio	Molecular biology
PD	Process development
Proc/Fin	Process/Finish
R&D	General R&D
Research	Research
RNA	RNA therapeutics
Security/Compliance	Security and compliance
SmallMolChem	Small molecule chemistry

Score Sources

Scores increment based on marketing touchpoints including:

- SFDC Campaign membership
- Webinar attendance
- Content downloads
- Email engagement
- Event attendance
- Website behavior
- Form submissions

Note for Campaign Owners: Please provide Persona alignment tags when creating campaigns to keep the scoring system robust.

Note for Content Owners/Users: Content tagging should be done in Airtable in the [Assets table](#) under Role and Topics

Calculation Logic

Inferred Persona Calculation Flow:

1. **Collect Inputs:** Gather all classification data (Seniority, Department, AI Interests, AI Persona)
2. **Sum Interest Scores:** Tally behavioral engagement across all score fields
3. **Apply Workato Logic:** Workflow determines the winning persona based on combined signals
4. **Populate MKTO Persona Result:** Intermediate calculation field
5. **Set Inferred Persona:** Final persona assignment based on MKTO Persona Result

The highest-scoring engagement area typically drives the Inferred Persona when demographic signals are ambiguous.

Data Flow Diagram

INPUT SOURCES			
Clay Enrichment	Marketo Behavioral	Manual	
• LinkedIn scrape	• Interest scores	• SDR input	
• Web search	• Campaign tags	• Form fills	
• AI classification	• Web activity		

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CLASSIFICATION FIELDS				
Seniority	Department	AI Interests	AI Persona	Scores

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| WORKATO WORKFLOW |

| Calculates winning persona match |

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| OUTPUT FIELDS |

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| MKTO Persona Result → Inferred Persona |

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Related Resources

Resource	Link
Full Mapping Details (Working Doc)	Google Sheet

Persona Visual Diagram	Lucidchart
Content Library Repository	Google Sheet
Academic Definition	Google Doc
New Persona Request	Jira Form

Archived Documentation

The following documents are superseded by this page:

Document	Status
Marketing Operations - Inferred Personas	Archived
FY23Q3 Inferred Persona v2	Archived
